

P&X

PHLOEM & XYLEM

Business Plan

Natural Resource & Urban Forestry Consulting

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Sandy Springs, Georgia

Table of Contents

- 1.** Executive Summary
- 2.** Company Overview
- 3.** Philosophy & Approach
- 4.** Services
- 5.** Target Market & Client Segments
- 6.** Competitive Advantage
- 7.** Business Model & Operations
- 8.** Marketing & Client Acquisition
- 9.** Financial Projections
- 10.** Growth Strategy & Milestones
- 11.** Legal & Entity Structure
- 12.** Risk Analysis

1. Executive Summary

P&X (Phloem & Xylem) is a natural resource and urban forestry consulting firm offering innovative, sustainable, and regenerative solutions to landscape and urban environmental challenges. Based in Sandy Springs, Georgia, P&X provides bespoke, white-glove consulting services to homeowners, commercial developers, engineering and consulting firms, neighborhoods, and private business owners across the greater Atlanta metropolitan area.

Founded by William Park — the City of Sandy Springs' Urban Forester and Sustainability Coordinator — P&X leverages deep public-sector expertise and an extensive network of trusted contractors, growers, and nurseries to deliver full-service solutions without the overhead of a traditional firm. William serves as the designer, operator, consultant, and subject matter expert on every engagement, subcontracting specialized execution work to vetted partners.

P&X operates as a part-time consultancy alongside William's full-time municipal role, with a business model designed for passive client acquisition and high-margin project delivery. The firm targets \$25,000–\$75,000 in annual revenue within its first two years, with a lean cost structure that positions it for strong profitability from day one.

Key Differentiators

- Root-cause, systems-level diagnostic approach — not symptom treatment
- Soil-first philosophy: what happens above ground is determined below it
- Full-service delivery through a curated subcontractor network
- Public-sector credibility combined with private-sector responsiveness
- Nature-based, regenerative solutions to urban landscape problems

2. Company Overview

Detail	Information
Company Name	P&X — Phloem & Xylem
Structure	Two-tier LLC (Wyoming holding + Georgia operating) — see Section 11
Principal	William Park
Location	Sandy Springs, Georgia
Operating Model	Part-time consultancy with subcontracted execution
Year Founded	2026
Industry	Natural Resource Consulting, Urban Forestry, Landscape Solutions
Service Area	Greater Atlanta Metro / North Georgia (expandable)

About the Principal

William Park currently serves as the Urban Forester and Sustainability Coordinator for the City of Sandy Springs, one of Georgia’s largest and most affluent municipalities. In this role, William manages the city’s urban forest, oversees tree preservation ordinances, coordinates sustainability initiatives, and works daily with developers, contractors, engineers, and residents on complex land-use and natural resource issues.

This position provides William with a unique vantage point: he understands the regulatory landscape, the development pipeline, the ecological challenges, and the stakeholder dynamics of the Atlanta region from the inside. P&X translates that institutional knowledge into private-sector consulting services that are informed, practical, and immediately actionable.

3. Philosophy & Approach

We Don't Treat Symptoms. We Find the Root Cause.

Most firms look at the canopy and treat what they see. P&X looks underground first. Soil health is everything — it dictates structure, resilience, longevity, and every visible symptom a client calls about. If the system below is out of balance, no amount of above-ground intervention will hold.

P&X doesn't grow trees. We remove the things standing in the way of trees growing. Compaction, nutrient imbalance, drainage failure, root conflict, regulatory barriers — our job is to diagnose what's truly wrong, not just what's visibly wrong, and restore the whole system to balance.

Holistic, Systems-Level Thinking

Every P&X engagement begins with a fundamental question: what is out of balance in this system that is manifesting the client's problem? A declining tree is rarely just a tree problem. It may be a soil problem, a drainage problem, a compaction problem from adjacent construction, a nutrient deficiency from decades of leaf removal, or a combination of interrelated stressors.

We take a holistic, comprehensive approach — examining the full ecosystem before prescribing solutions. This means our recommendations last longer, cost less over time, and address the actual cause rather than cycling through repeated surface-level treatments.

Nature-Based & Regenerative Solutions

P&X prioritizes solutions that work with natural systems rather than against them. Bioswales over hardscape drainage. Soil biology restoration over chemical fertilization. Native and adapted species over ornamental monocultures. Regenerative land management over extractive maintenance practices. This approach delivers better long-term outcomes, aligns with growing market demand for sustainability, and positions P&X at the leading edge of the industry.

4. Services

P&X offers a comprehensive suite of natural resource and landscape consulting services. William serves as the diagnostic expert, designer, and project lead on all engagements. Specialized field work, installation, and maintenance are executed through a curated network of trusted subcontractors, growers, and nurseries.

Landscape Diagnostics & Root-Cause Analysis

Comprehensive site assessments that start below the surface. Soil testing, root-zone evaluation, hydrology analysis, and ecosystem health mapping to identify the true drivers of landscape decline or underperformance.

Urban Tree Consulting

Tree risk assessment, preservation planning, inventory and GIS mapping, species selection, planting design, and long-term canopy management strategies for residential, commercial, and municipal properties.

Regenerative Landscape Design

Nature-based design solutions that restore ecological function: native plantings, pollinator habitat, rain gardens, bioswales, soil remediation, and integrated stormwater management. Designed to be beautiful, functional, and self-sustaining.

Construction & Development Consulting

Tree preservation plans, root protection zones, transplant feasibility studies, grading impact assessments, and on-site monitoring during construction. Helping developers meet ordinance requirements while protecting natural assets.

Soil Health & Remediation

Soil compaction mitigation, biological inoculant programs, organic amendment plans, drainage redesign, and long-term soil restoration strategies. The foundation of every healthy landscape.

Consulting for Consultants

Subject matter expertise for engineering firms, landscape architecture studios, and other consultancies that need arboricultural or ecological knowledge on their project teams. P&X serves as a specialized subconsultant on multidisciplinary projects.

Grant & Funding Support

Identification and pursuit of federal, state, and foundation funding for tree planting, green infrastructure, and sustainability projects. Proposal writing and program design for organizations seeking USDA, EPA, or state-level grants.

Emergency & Storm Response

Rapid post-storm damage assessment, hazard tree evaluation, debris management coordination, and recovery planning. Insurance documentation support and replanting design.

5. Target Market & Client Segments

P&X serves a diverse client base across the residential, commercial, and professional services sectors in the greater Atlanta metropolitan area. The firm's positioning as a full-service provider — with the credibility of a public-sector professional and the flexibility of a private consultant — appeals to clients who want expert-level guidance without the overhead of a large firm.

Individual Homeowners

High-value residential property owners in Sandy Springs, Buckhead, Brookhaven, Dunwoody, and surrounding affluent communities. These clients face declining trees, drainage issues, landscape renovation decisions, and construction impacts on mature canopy. They want a trusted expert — not a sales pitch from a tree service company.

Typical engagement range: \$2,000–\$8,000 per engagement

Commercial Developers

Developers building residential subdivisions, mixed-use projects, and commercial properties who need tree surveys, preservation plans, ordinance compliance, and landscape design that satisfies municipal requirements while maximizing buildable area.

Typical engagement range: \$5,000–\$25,000 per project

Engineering & Consulting Firms

Civil engineering, environmental, and landscape architecture firms that need arboricultural or ecological subject matter expertise on their project teams. P&X serves as a specialized subconsultant, providing tree assessments, environmental reviews, and expert testimony.

Typical engagement range: \$3,000–\$15,000 per project

Neighborhoods & HOAs

Homeowner associations and neighborhood groups managing common-area landscapes, community tree programs, stormwater issues, and long-range landscape planning. Often grant-eligible projects.

Typical engagement range: \$3,000–\$12,000 per engagement

Private Company Owners

Owners of commercial properties, retail centers, office parks, and industrial sites who need landscape assessment, tree management, liability mitigation, or site improvement consulting.

Typical engagement range: \$2,500–\$10,000 per engagement

6. Competitive Advantage

P&X occupies a unique position in the Atlanta market. Most competitors fall into one of two categories: large environmental consulting firms with high overhead and generalist staff, or small tree service companies that focus on removal and pruning. P&X sits between them — offering deep technical expertise with the agility and personal attention of a boutique practice.

- **Institutional Knowledge:** William's role as Sandy Springs' Urban Forester provides an intimate understanding of municipal processes, development review, tree ordinances, and the regulatory environment that most private consultants lack.
- **Systems-Level Diagnostics:** While competitors treat visible symptoms, P&X investigates root causes. This approach produces better outcomes, reduces repeat interventions, and builds lasting client trust.
- **Full-Service Without Full-Time Staff:** By subcontracting execution to trusted partners, P&X delivers the scope of a large firm with the economics of a sole practitioner. No payroll overhead, no idle capacity, no markup on labor that doesn't add value.
- **Curated Subcontractor Network:** Established relationships with contractors, growers, and nurseries mean P&X can source quality plant material, skilled labor, and specialized equipment quickly and at competitive rates.
- **Credibility & Trust:** A public-sector professional offering private consulting carries inherent credibility. Clients know William's recommendations are grounded in public interest and ecological science, not upselling.
- **Nature-Based Solutions Expertise:** Growing demand for regenerative, sustainable, and green infrastructure approaches gives P&X a market advantage as municipalities and developers increasingly require these approaches.

7. Business Model & Operations

Operating Structure

P&X operates as a part-time consultancy alongside William’s full-time position with the City of Sandy Springs. All consulting work is performed outside of city work hours, on weekends, and during personal time. The business model is designed around this constraint, prioritizing efficiency, passive client acquisition, and high-value engagements over volume.

Revenue Model

P&X generates revenue through three primary channels:

- Consulting fees for diagnostics, design, and project management (hourly and project-based)
- Markup on subcontracted installation, maintenance, and material procurement (15–25%)
- Retainer agreements for ongoing landscape management and advisory services

Role Definition

Function	Handled By
Client consultation & intake	William (P&X)
Site assessment & diagnostics	William (P&X)
Design & recommendations	William (P&X)
Proposal & scope development	William (P&X)
Project management & oversight	William (P&X)
Tree work & pruning	Subcontracted arborist crews
Planting & installation	Subcontracted landscape contractors
Soil remediation & amendment	Subcontracted specialists
Plant material sourcing	Partner nurseries & growers
Hardscape & drainage	Subcontracted contractors

Cost Structure

P&X operates with minimal fixed costs. The primary expenses are professional liability insurance, business licensing, marketing materials, and software/tools. Subcontractor costs are passed through to clients with a management markup, meaning the majority of direct project costs are variable and tied to revenue.

Expense Category	Estimated Annual Cost	Notes
Business insurance (GL + E&O)	\$1,500–\$3,000	Required for consulting

Business license & LLC filing	\$200–\$400	Georgia LLC + Sandy Springs business license
Website & domain	\$200–\$500	Hosting, domain, email
Software & tools	\$500–\$1,200	GIS, soil testing kits, design software
Marketing & branding	\$500–\$2,000	Business cards, signage, initial collateral
Professional development	\$300–\$800	ISA CEUs, conferences
Vehicle & fuel (incremental)	\$500–\$1,500	Additional mileage for client sites
Total Fixed Overhead	\$3,700–\$9,400	Low overhead = high margins

8. Marketing & Client Acquisition Strategy

Because P&X operates part-time, the marketing strategy prioritizes passive and referral-based client acquisition. The goal is to build a reputation engine that generates inbound inquiries without requiring active prospecting or cold outreach.

Passive Acquisition Channels

- **Professional Reputation & Word of Mouth:** William's visibility as Sandy Springs' Urban Forester creates organic awareness. Every interaction with developers, residents, HOAs, and contractors is a potential referral source. This is the primary growth engine and costs nothing.
- **Website & SEO:** The P&X website (phloemandxylem.com) is designed to attract organic search traffic for queries like "tree consultant Atlanta," "urban forestry consulting Georgia," and "soil health landscape assessment." Blog content on regenerative landscaping and nature-based solutions will build domain authority over time.
- **Subcontractor & Partner Referrals:** Contractors, nurseries, and landscape companies who don't offer consulting services will refer clients to P&X for diagnostics, design, and project management. In return, P&X refers execution work back to them. This creates a symbiotic referral loop.
- **Professional Network & Associations:** Active membership in ISA (International Society of Arboriculture), Georgia Urban Forest Council, Georgia Arborist Association, and local chambers of commerce. Conference presentations and published articles establish thought leadership.
- **Social Media & Content:** A low-effort but consistent presence on LinkedIn and Instagram. Case study posts, before/after project photos, and educational content about soil health and regenerative approaches. Targeted at the Atlanta market.

Referral Strategy

The most important marketing investment is the quality of P&X's work. Every project is a portfolio piece and a referral source. The strategy is straightforward: deliver exceptional results, maintain relationships, and make it easy for satisfied clients and partners to send new business. A simple referral acknowledgment — a thank-you note or small gift — reinforces the behavior without creating a formal (and potentially awkward) referral program.

9. Financial Projections

The following projections are conservative estimates based on part-time operations, the Atlanta market, and typical consulting rates for arboricultural and natural resource professionals.

Year 1: Foundation (2026–2027)

Metric	Conservative	Target	Stretch
Active projects	8–10	12–15	18–20
Average project value	\$2,500	\$3,500	\$4,000
Gross revenue	\$22,500	\$45,000	\$75,000
Subcontractor pass-through	\$8,000	\$18,000	\$35,000
Consulting revenue (net)	\$14,500	\$27,000	\$40,000
Operating expenses	\$5,000	\$7,000	\$9,000
Net income	\$9,500	\$20,000	\$31,000

Year 2: Growth (2027–2028)

Metric	Conservative	Target	Stretch
Active projects	15–18	20–25	30+
Average project value	\$3,500	\$4,500	\$5,500
Gross revenue	\$56,000	\$100,000	\$150,000+
Subcontractor pass-through	\$25,000	\$50,000	\$80,000
Consulting revenue (net)	\$31,000	\$50,000	\$70,000
Operating expenses	\$7,000	\$9,000	\$12,000
Net income	\$24,000	\$41,000	\$58,000

Pricing Framework

Service Type	Rate Structure	Typical Range
Initial consultation	Flat fee	\$250–\$500
Site assessment & diagnostics	Project-based	\$1,500–\$5,000

Design & planning	Project-based	\$2,500–\$10,000
Project management	Hourly or % of project	\$125–\$175/hr or 10–15%
Expert testimony / legal support	Hourly	\$200–\$300/hr
Retainer (ongoing advisory)	Monthly	\$500–\$2,000/mo
Subcontractor markup	% of subcontract cost	15–25%

10. Growth Strategy & Milestones

Phase 1: Launch & Establish (Months 1–6)

- Formalize LLC and obtain business license and insurance
- Launch website and establish basic social media presence
- Activate subcontractor network and formalize partner agreements
- Complete first 3–5 projects to build portfolio and testimonials
- Establish referral relationships with 5–10 contractors and firms

Phase 2: Build Reputation (Months 6–12)

- Publish 2–4 case studies on the website
- Begin content marketing (blog, LinkedIn, Instagram)
- Target 1–2 engineering/consulting firm subconsulting relationships
- Attend and present at 1–2 industry events or local conferences
- Reach \$25,000+ in cumulative revenue

Phase 3: Scale & Specialize (Year 2)

- Develop a signature service offering (e.g., “Soil-First Landscape Audit”)
- Pursue HOA and neighborhood contracts for recurring revenue
- Explore grant writing as a service line for municipalities and nonprofits
- Evaluate whether to transition P&X toward full-time (based on demand)
- Target \$50,000–\$75,000+ in annual revenue

Long-Term Vision

P&X is designed to scale on William’s terms. If demand warrants it, the firm can transition from a part-time practice to a full-time consultancy, potentially bringing on associate consultants or expanding the subcontractor network into new geographies. The model is intentionally flexible: it works as a high-margin side business and as the foundation for a larger firm, depending on where the market and William’s career trajectory lead.

11. Legal & Entity Structure

P&X's entity structure is designed to maximize two priorities: personal liability protection and ownership privacy. Because the principal operates P&X alongside a full-time municipal role, maintaining clear separation between public and private professional identities is essential.

Recommended Structure: Two-Tier LLC

The recommended approach is a two-layer LLC structure that leverages Wyoming's strong privacy protections with Georgia's requirement for a local operating entity.

Layer	Entity	State	Purpose
Holding Company	PX Holdings LLC	Wyoming	Owns the Georgia LLC; provides ownership anonymity (WY does not require member disclosure on public filings)
Operating Company	P&X LLC (Phloem & Xylem)	Georgia	Conducts all business activity; listed member is the Wyoming LLC, not the individual

Why Wyoming?

- No requirement to disclose member or manager names on Articles of Organization
- No state income tax
- Low annual report fee (~\$60/year)
- Strong charging order protection (asset protection for single-member LLCs)
- Well-established legal precedent and business-friendly courts

How It Works

The Wyoming LLC (PX Holdings) is formed first through a registered agent service, which also provides the entity's address of record — so neither William's name nor home address appears on any Wyoming public filing. The Georgia LLC (P&X) is then formed listing the Wyoming LLC as its sole member. Georgia's public records show P&X LLC owned by PX Holdings LLC — and Wyoming's records do not reveal who owns PX Holdings.

Each entity obtains its own EIN (Employer Identification Number) from the IRS. A registered agent service is used in both states so that no personal address appears on any filing. Banking is set up under the Georgia LLC's EIN for operating purposes.

Privacy Protections Summary

Record / Filing	What's Publicly Visible	What's Protected
Georgia Secretary of State	P&X LLC; Member: PX Holdings LLC (WY)	William's name and home address
Wyoming Secretary of State	PX Holdings LLC; Registered Agent address	Member/manager identity
IRS (EIN records)	Not publicly searchable	All ownership information
Business bank account	Not public	All account details

S-Corp Tax Election

An S-Corp election (IRS Form 2553) allows LLC owners to reduce self-employment tax by splitting income between a “reasonable salary” (subject to payroll tax) and distributions (not subject to payroll tax). This election is made at the IRS level and does not change the LLC’s state registration or privacy structure.

The S-Corp election typically becomes advantageous when net self-employment income exceeds \$40,000–\$50,000 annually. Given P&X’s Year 1 revenue target of \$25,000–\$75,000, this election may not provide meaningful savings initially but should be evaluated in Year 2 as revenue grows. The added complexity includes running payroll (even if only to yourself) and additional tax filings.

Formation Costs & Timeline

Item	Estimated Cost	Notes
Wyoming LLC filing	\$100	State filing fee
Wyoming registered agent (annual)	\$50–\$150/year	Privacy address service
Georgia LLC filing	\$100	State filing fee
Georgia registered agent (annual)	\$50–\$150/year	Privacy address service
Georgia annual registration	\$50/year	Required annually
Business attorney review	\$500–\$1,500	Recommended: confirm structure and draft operating agreements
Total Year 1 formation cost	\$850–\$2,150	One-time setup plus first-year fees

Key Legal Considerations

- Confirm with Sandy Springs HR/legal that private consulting is permitted and identify any conflict-of-interest disclosure requirements. P&X does not compete for municipal contracts and serves only private-sector clients.
- Draft an Operating Agreement for both LLCs that defines management authority, distribution policies, and dissolution procedures.
- Obtain both general liability (GL) and professional liability / errors & omissions (E&O) insurance under the Georgia LLC before accepting any client work.
- Use written contracts for all client engagements with limitation of liability clauses, indemnification provisions, and clear scope definitions.
- Consult a CPA for tax planning, especially around the timing of an S-Corp election and quarterly estimated tax payments.

12. Risk Analysis

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation Strategy
Time constraints from full-time role	Medium	Business model designed for passive acquisition; project scheduling on evenings/weekends; subcontractors handle execution-heavy work
Conflict of interest concerns	Low-Medium	P&X does not compete for municipal contracts; consulting is for private clients only; full transparency with employer; legal review of any potential overlap
Subcontractor quality / reliability	Medium	Vet all partners thoroughly; maintain backup relationships; use clear scopes of work and contracts; quality control through on-site oversight
Slow initial client acquisition	Medium	Low fixed costs mean breakeven is low; leverage existing professional network from day one; referral strategy reduces dependence on marketing spend
Liability exposure	Low-Medium	Professional liability (E&O) insurance; general liability insurance; LLC structure for personal asset protection; clear contracts with limitation of liability clauses
Market downturn / construction slowdown	Low	Service diversity across residential, commercial, and institutional sectors; homeowner and HOA work is less cyclical than development-driven consulting

P&X — Phloem & Xylem

Innovative & Sustainable Solutions for Natural Resource & Urban Forestry Challenges